

CHECKLIST

Wikipedia Notability Checklist

The signals editors look for, in a format you can honestly assess yourself against before you consider a page.

PDF · A4 · Self-assessment

Authority. Recognition. Trust.

Before you begin

Most people ask how to get a Wikipedia page. The question that decides the outcome is different: are you notable enough to keep one? Notability is a specific bar. It is verifiable significance, evidenced by independent, credible sources that have already taken you seriously.

This checklist turns that bar into criteria you can score yourself against, honestly and in private. Work through each section and tick only what is genuinely true today, not what you hope will be true soon.

Notability is not how well-known you are. It is whether independent people, with no stake in you, have written about you in a way that can be checked.

Educational self-assessment only. Meeting these criteria does not guarantee a page, and no one can ethically guarantee one. This is not legal or editorial advice.

1. Independent sources

The whole game is sources you did not commission or control. Tick each that is genuinely true.

- ☐ Independent publications have written about the business or its leadership.
- ☐ That coverage was not paid for, placed, or written by us.
- ☐ The coverage discusses us in depth, not as a passing mention in a list.
- ☐ At least two or three separate, unrelated sources exist.
- ☐ A stranger could find these sources without our help.

2. Media coverage

Not all coverage carries the same weight. Quality and independence matter more than volume.

- ☐ Coverage appears in outlets with editorial standards and a reputation of their own.
- ☐ The outlets are not content farms or pay-to-publish sites.
- ☐ The reporting is substantial, not a reworded press release.
- ☐ Coverage has appeared across time, not in a single burst.

3. Awards and formal recognition

Recognition counts when it is selective and independently verifiable.

- ☐ Any awards were granted by credible, independent bodies.

- ☐ The awards are selective, not open to anyone who applies or pays.
- ☐ The recognition can be verified by a third party.

4. Books and published references

- ☐ The business or its leadership is referenced in books or long-form work.
- ☐ Those references were written by independent authors.
- ☐ The references are substantive, not incidental.

5. Executive reputation

A leader's public record often carries the notability case, or reveals the gap.

- ☐ Key executives have an independent, verifiable public record.
- ☐ They have been quoted, interviewed, or profiled by credible outlets.
- ☐ Their expertise is recognised beyond our own channels.

6. Search footprint

Search is where a stranger forms a first, fast judgment.

- ☐ Searching our name surfaces independent sources, not only our own pages.
- ☐ The results are consistent and free of obvious contradictions.
- ☐ There is a coherent, credible picture a stranger could reconstruct.

7. Industry recognition

- ☐ Peers or specialists reference us as a point of authority.
- ☐ We are cited or invited on the strength of our expertise.
- ☐ That recognition is visible to people outside our immediate network.

What does not count

However much it feels like it should, none of the following establishes notability on its own:

- Your own website, profiles, and press releases. These are you talking about you.
- Directory listings and paid placements. Presence is not the same as recognition.
- Social media reach. A large following is visibility, not verifiable significance.

- Sponsored content and advertorials. Paid coverage is not independent coverage.

Your readiness summary

Count the boxes you could genuinely tick, then read the result honestly.

Independent sources (of 5)
Media coverage (of 4)
Awards and recognition (of 3)
Books and references (of 3)
Executive reputation (of 3)
Search footprint (of 3)
Industry recognition (of 3)

Reading your result

- Strong across most sections: a page may be worth exploring, and the process becomes largely mechanical.
- Strong in a few, thin in others: build the missing reference points first. A page attempted now invites deletion.
- Thin across the board: this is your starting point, not a verdict. Earn independent recognition before revisiting Wikipedia at all.

Sometimes the right answer is "not yet." On Wikipedia more than anywhere, "not yet" is often the answer that protects you.